How to Focus When Distracted and Start Deep Work Instantly

By the end of this worksheet you will have put "How to start a focus session when you feel distracted" into practice at least once.

Your action steps

[ ] 1. Clear your immediate visual field
Start by physically clearing your desk of everything except the absolute essentials for your next task.
Notes: _____

[ ] 2. Exile your digital distraction devices
Pick up your smartphone, turn it completely silent, and physically place it in another room or inside a closed drawer at least ten feet away from your chair.
Notes: _____

[ ] 3. Change your physical posture and state
Stand up from your chair, stretch your arms high above your head, and take three slow, deep diaphragmatic breaths to reset your nervous system.
Notes: _____

[ ] 4. Write down one micro-step on paper
Take a physical notepad and write down the single smallest, most low-friction action you need to take to start your work.
Notes: _____

[ ] 5. Set a physical five-minute timer
Use a physical kitchen timer, a simple wristwatch, or a dedicated desktop app to set a countdown timer for exactly five minutes.
Notes: _____

Reflection

Which step felt easiest, and which one did you avoid?

_____

What got in the way, and what is one small change that would help tomorrow?

_____

What will you do differently in your next session?

_____

7-day check-in

Day 1: [ ] Practiced Minutes: _____ One-line note: _____
Day 2: [ ] Practiced Minutes: _____ One-line note: _____
Day 3: [ ] Practiced Minutes: _____ One-line note: _____
Day 4: [ ] Practiced Minutes: _____ One-line note: _____
Day 5: [ ] Practiced Minutes: _____ One-line note: _____
Day 6: [ ] Practiced Minutes: _____ One-line note: _____
Day 7: [ ] Practiced Minutes: _____ One-line note: _____

This is a practical exercise, not professional advice. Adapt it to your own routine.